

Word family: **dramatic / dramatically / drama / dramatize / dramatise / dramatization / dramatisation**

Base word: dramatic

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**

Related forms:

* **dramatic** (adj.) — 戲劇性的；突然而巨大的；誇張的；與戲劇有關的

* **dramatically** (adv.) — 戲劇性地；大幅地；誇張地

* **drama** (n.) — 戲劇；戲劇性事件；風波

* **dramatize / dramatise** (v.) — 戲劇化；把.....改編成戲劇；誇大

* **dramatization / dramatisation** (n.) — 戲劇化改編；戲劇化呈現

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **dramatic change**

* **dramatic increase / decrease**

* **dramatic improvement**

* **dramatic effect**

* **dramatic scene**

* **dramatic entrance**

* **dramatic pause**

* **dramatic voice**

* **dramatic reaction**

* **overly dramatic**

* **be dramatic**

* **drama series**

* **dramatize an event**

Meaning in this passage

> I had to sort through hundreds of old photos, choose the right ones, and write messages that sounded sincere instead of overly **dramatic**.

Here, **dramatic** means:

expressing emotion in an exaggerated, theatrical, or overly intense way — 太誇張的；太煽情的；過分戲劇化的

The speaker wanted the messages to sound heartfelt, but not as though they were trying too hard to create strong emotion.

中文翻譯：

我需要從幾百張舊照片裏慢慢挑選合適的，再寫上一些真誠而不會太**煽情 / 太誇張**的留言。

So here:

overly dramatic = 情緒表達過火、太煽情、太像戲劇演出一樣誇張

1. **dramatic (戲劇性的；充滿戲劇張力的) — 戲劇性的**

This is the core sense connected to **drama**.

Practice 1

> The film has several **dramatic scenes**.

這部電影有幾個很**戲劇性的場面**。

Practice 2

> The story reaches a **dramatic climax**.

故事到達一個**戲劇性高潮**。

Practice 3

> Her entrance was deliberately **dramatic**.

她的登場刻意營造得很**戲劇化**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****dramatic = having the qualities of drama, with strong emotion, tension, or striking action****

中文：

****帶有戲劇感、強烈情緒、張力或突出效果的****

2. **dramatic (突然而巨大的) — 巨大的；顯著的；劇烈的**

A major separate sense.

Practice 1

> There was a **dramatic increase** in prices.

價格出現**大幅上升**。

Practice 2

> The treatment led to a **dramatic improvement**.

治療帶來了**顯著改善**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatic = very large, sudden, or noticeable in effect or degree

中文：

幅度很大、變化明顯或效果非常突出的

3. **dramatic change** — 巨大變化；劇烈改變

Practice 1

> The area has undergone a **dramatic change**.

這個地區經歷了**巨大變化**。

Practice 2

> There was a **dramatic change** in his attitude.

他的態度出現了**明顯而劇烈的改變**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatic change = a very large or striking change

4. **dramatic increase / rise** — 大幅增加 / 上升

Practice 1

> Sales showed a **dramatic increase**.

銷售額出現**大幅增長**。

Practice 2

> There was a **dramatic rise** in demand.

需求出現**急劇上升**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatic increase/rise = a large and noticeable increase over a relatively short period

5. **dramatic decrease / drop — 大幅下降**

Practice 1

> The company saw a **dramatic drop** in costs.

公司成本出現**大幅下降**。

Practice 2

> Pollution levels fell **dramatically**.

污染水平**大幅下降**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatic decrease/drop = a large and obvious reduction

6. **dramatic improvement — 顯著改善**

Practice 1

> Her English showed a **dramatic improvement**.

她的英文有了**顯著改善**。

Practice 2

> The new system produced **dramatic improvements** in efficiency.

新系統令效率出現**大幅提升**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatic improvement = improvement that is large and clearly noticeable

7. ****dramatic effect / impact — 強烈效果；重大影響****

Practice 1

> The new lighting had a ****dramatic effect**** on the room.

新的燈光對房間產生了****強烈效果****。

Practice 2

> The decision had a ****dramatic impact**** on the business.

這個決定對公司產生了****重大影響****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****dramatic effect/impact = a very strong or noticeable effect****

8. ****dramatic (誇張的；情緒過火的) — 誇張的；煽情的****

This is the sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original context

> I wanted the messages to sound sincere instead of overly ****dramatic****.

我希望那些留言聽起來真誠，而不是太****煽情 / 誇張****。

Practice 2

> Don't be so ****dramatic****—it's only a small problem.

別那麼****誇張****——這只是一個小問題。

Practice 3

> His reaction was far too ****dramatic****.

他的反應實在太****誇張****了。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****dramatic = showing or expressing more emotion, seriousness, or intensity than the situation**

seems to require**

中文：

情緒或反應比實際情況所需要的更強烈、更誇張

9. **be dramatic — 很誇張；反應過火**

Practice 1

> You're **being dramatic**.

你太**誇張了**。

Practice 2

> She tends to **be dramatic** when she's upset.

她不開心時往往會**反應比較誇張**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be dramatic = behave in an exaggeratedly emotional or theatrical way

10. **overly dramatic — 過分戲劇化；太煽情**

Practice 1

> The speech felt **overly dramatic**.

那篇演講感覺**過分煽情**。

Practice 2

> Keep the message warm without becoming **overly dramatic**.

讓訊息保持溫暖，但不要變得**太煽情**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overly dramatic = more emotional, theatrical, or exaggerated than is appropriate

11. **dramatic reaction — 強烈 / 誇張反應**

This phrase can have two readings depending on context.

Practice 1

> She had a **dramatic reaction** to the news.

她對消息有很**強烈的反應**。

Practice 2

> His **dramatic reaction** made everyone stare.

他那個很**誇張的反應**令所有人都望着他。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatic reaction = a reaction that is either very strong or noticeably exaggerated

Context decides whether the meaning is neutral or critical.

12. **dramatic pause — 戲劇性停頓；故意停頓製造效果**

Practice 1

> He took a **dramatic pause** before announcing the result.

他宣布結果前故意作了一個**戲劇性停頓**。

Practice 2

> She paused **dramatically** before answering.

她回答前**很戲劇化地停頓了一下**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatic pause = a deliberate silence used to create tension, emphasis, or suspense

13. **dramatic voice / tone — 戲劇化語氣；誇張語調**

Practice 1

> He read the letter in a **dramatic voice**.

他用很**戲劇化的語氣**讀那封信。

Practice 2

> She used a **dramatic tone** to make the story sound exciting.

她用了很**戲劇性的語調**令故事更刺激。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatic voice/tone = an expressive, theatrical, or emotionally intense speaking style

14. **dramatic entrance** — **戲劇性登場；高調登場**

Practice 1

> He made a **dramatic entrance**.

他來了一次很**戲劇性的登場**。

Practice 2

> She arrived late and made a **dramatic entrance**.

她遲到後以很**高調戲劇化的方式登場**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatic entrance = an arrival designed to attract strong attention

15. **dramatic arts** — **戲劇藝術**

Practice 1

> She studied **dramatic arts** at university.

她在大學修讀**戲劇藝術**。

Practice 2

> The school has a strong **dramatic arts** programme.

學校有很好的**戲劇藝術課程**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatic arts = acting, theatre, and related forms of performance

16. **dramatic performance — 戲劇表演；強烈戲劇演出**

Practice 1

> The actor gave a powerful **dramatic performance**.

那位演員帶來了一場很有感染力的**戲劇表演**。

Practice 2

> Students prepared a short **dramatic performance**.

學生準備了一段短**戲劇演出**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatic performance = a theatrical or acting performance

17. **dramatically (大幅地；顯著地) — 大幅地；劇烈地**

Practice 1

> Prices rose **dramatically**.

價格**大幅上升**。

Practice 2

> The situation improved **dramatically**.

情況**顯著改善**。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatically = by a very large or noticeable amount

18. **dramatically (戲劇性地；誇張地) — 戲劇性地；誇張地**

Practice 1

> She sighed **dramatically**.

她**很誇張地**嘆了一口氣。

Practice 2

> He threw his hands up **dramatically**.

他**戲劇化地**把雙手舉起。

MCQ-ready definition:

dramatically = in an emotionally exaggerated or theatrical way

19. **drama (戲劇 ; 戲劇作品) — 戲劇 ; 劇集**

Practice 1

> She studied **drama** at school.

她在學校修讀**戲劇**。

Practice 2

> We watched a historical **drama**.

我們看了一套歷史**劇集 / 戲劇作品**。

MCQ-ready definition:

drama = plays, acting, or serious fictional works performed on stage, television, or film

20. **drama (風波 ; 麻煩 ; 情緒衝突) — 風波 ; 是非 ; 麻煩**

Informal.

Practice 1

> I don't want any **drama**.

我不想惹任何**麻煩 / 風波**。

Practice 2

> There was a lot of **drama** in the group last week.

那個群組上星期有很多**是非 / 情緒衝突**。

MCQ-ready definition:

drama = informal: emotional conflict, arguments, or unnecessary excitement

21. **no drama** — 沒問題；不用麻煩

Especially AusE/NZE informal, but also understood more broadly.

Practice 1

> “Thanks for helping.” “**No drama**.”

「多謝你幫忙。」 「**沒問題**。」

Practice 2

> It's **no drama** if you're a few minutes late.

你遲幾分鐘也**沒甚麼問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

no drama = informal: no problem / don't worry about it

22. **dramatize / dramatise** (戲劇化改編) — 改編成戲劇

Practice 1

> The novel was **dramatized** for television.

這本小說被**改編成電視劇**。

Practice 2

> The documentary **dramatizes** several historical events.

紀錄片把幾件歷史事件**戲劇化呈現**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****dramatize = turn a real or fictional story into dramatic form for performance****

23. ****dramatize / dramatiser (把事情說得太誇張) — 誇大 ; 戲劇化****

Practice 1

> Don't ****dramatize the situation****.

不要把情況****說得太誇張****。

Practice 2

> He tends to ****dramatize small problems****.

他很容易把小問題****戲劇化 / 誇大****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****dramatize = make a situation seem more exciting, serious, or emotional than it really is****

24. ****dramatization / dramatisation — 戲劇化改編 ; 戲劇化呈現****

Practice 1

> The film is a ****dramatization**** of real events.

這部電影是根據真實事件作出的****戲劇化改編****。

Practice 2

> Some scenes were added for ****dramatisation****.

有些場景是為了增加****戲劇效果****而加入。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****dramatization = a dramatic adaptation or presentation of events****

Important distinction 1: ****dramatic vs emotional****

emotional

simply means involving or showing strong feelings.

dramatic

can imply:

- * theatricality
- * striking effect
- * exaggerated intensity

A message can be emotional without being dramatic.

In your passage, that is exactly the goal:

> sincere and emotional 

> overly dramatic 

Important distinction 2: **dramatic vs exaggerated**

exaggerated

specifically means made to seem bigger/more serious than reality.

dramatic

can be exaggerated, but can also simply mean powerful or striking.

> dramatic increase

does **not** mean “fake/exaggerated increase.”

It means a genuinely large increase.

Important distinction 3: **dramatic = large vs dramatic = theatrical**

These are the two biggest learner branches.

Degree

> a dramatic increase

大幅增加

Behaviour/style

> a dramatic reaction

戲劇化 / 誇張反應

Context decides.

Important distinction 4: **dramatic vs drastic**

Often confused.

dramatic

very large, striking, or theatrical.

drastic

extreme and often severe, especially an action/change taken to solve a problem.

> dramatic improvement

顯著改善

> drastic measures

激烈 / 嚴厲措施

They are not interchangeable.

Important distinction 5: **dramatic vs theatrical**

theatrical

strongly suggests stage-like, performative behaviour.

dramatic

broader:

- * theatrical
- * emotionally intense
- * large/striking

So **dramatic** has a wider range.

Important distinction 6: **dramatic vs serious**

serious

important, severe, or not humorous.

dramatic

striking, emotional, or large in effect.

A serious problem is not necessarily dramatic; a dramatic scene is not necessarily serious.

Important distinction 7: **dramatic change vs sudden change**

dramatic change

large and striking.

sudden change

happens quickly.

A change can be dramatic without being sudden, and sudden without being dramatic.

Important distinction 8: **dramatic effect vs special effect**

dramatic effect

a strong or theatrical impact.

special effect

technical visual/audio effect in film or performance.

Different meanings.

Important distinction 9: **be dramatic vs be upset**

be upset

genuinely feel unhappy/distressed.

be dramatic

often implies expressing feelings more intensely than the situation seems to require.

Calling someone “dramatic” can therefore sound critical.

Important distinction 10: **drama vs dramatic**

drama

noun:

- * theatre
- * fictional serious work
- * interpersonal conflict

dramatic

adjective:

- * related to drama
- * striking
- * exaggerated

Important distinction 11: **drama = TV genre vs drama = interpersonal conflict**

Genre

> a television drama

電視劇

Informal

> workplace drama

職場是非 / 風波

These are distinct modern senses.

Important distinction 12: **dramatize = adapt vs exaggerate**

Adapt

> dramatize a novel

把小說改編成戲劇

Exaggerate

> dramatize a problem

把問題說得太誇張

Same verb, genuinely different senses.

Family-extension note

Dramatic has four major modern branches:

1. **related to drama/theatre**

* dramatic arts

* dramatic performance

2. **large and striking**

* dramatic change

* dramatic increase

* dramatic improvement

3. **emotionally/theatrically intense**

- * dramatic entrance
- * dramatic pause
- * dramatic reaction

4. **overly emotional / exaggerated**

- * be dramatic
- * overly dramatic

The family then expands into:

5. **drama**

- * theatrical work
- * informal conflict/chaos

6. **dramatize**

- * adapt into dramatic form
- * exaggerate

For your passage, the relevant sense is:

dramatic = emotionally exaggerated / too theatrical

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
dramatic (theatre)	戲劇性的	drama-related	
dramatic scene	戲劇性場面	strong tension	
dramatic change	巨大 / 劇烈變化	striking change	
dramatic increase	大幅增加	large rise	
dramatic decrease	大幅下降	large drop	
dramatic improvement	顯著改善	major improvement	
dramatic effect	強烈效果	strong impact	
dramatic (behaviour)	誇張的；戲劇化的	theatrical expression	
overly dramatic	太煽情；太誇張	excessive emotion	
dramatic reaction	強烈 / 誇張反應	intense response	
dramatic pause	戲劇性停頓	suspense	
dramatic tone	戲劇化語氣	theatrical style	
dramatic entrance	戲劇性登場	attention-grabbing arrival	
dramatically (degree)	大幅地；顯著地	large degree	
dramatically (manner)	誇張地；戲劇性地	theatrical manner	

drama	戲劇；劇集	performed story	
drama (informal)	風波；是非	emotional conflict	
dramatize (adapt)	改編成戲劇	dramatic adaptation	
dramatize (exaggerate)	誇大；戲劇化	make seem more intense	
dramatization	戲劇化改編	adaptation	

For your original sentence

> I had to sort through hundreds of old photos, choose the right ones, and write messages that sounded sincere instead of overly **dramatic**.

Here:

overly dramatic = 太煽情、太誇張、情緒表達過火

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我需要從幾百張舊照片裏慢慢挑選合適的，再寫上一些聽起來真誠而不會太**煽情**的留言。

The key contrast is:

> **sincere** = 真誠、有感情但自然

> **overly dramatic** = 情緒太滿、太像刻意催淚或演戲

For this sentence, **「太煽情」** captures the nuance especially well.